```
      if (header.toLowerCase().indexOf('x-') === 0) {
        resHeaders.push(header);
      }
    }
    return resHeaders.join(',');
  }
```

This function is different from the one before because it actually parses and looks at the values in the Access-Control-Request-Headers header. It only returns those requested header values that start with an X-. For example, if the client sends the following request header:

```
Access-Control-Request-Headers: X-One, Two, Three, X-Four
```

the server will reply with the following response header:

```
Access-Control-Allow-Headers: X-One, X-Four
```

`X-One` and `X-Four` are allowed because they begin with `X-`, while header values `Two` and `Three` don't. If a developer inspects the preflight request and response, he or she can easily see which header values were requested and which were allowed.

This is just one example of the nuanced ways you can control the Access-Control-Allow-Headers header. If your own server has different request header requirements, you can tailor it any way you see fit.

6.6 Reducing preflight requests

While preflight requests are an important form of server protection, the additional HTTP request can be a performance hit. This is especially true for resource-constrained environments where HTTP requests are expensive, such as mobile devices. Therefore, it's useful to try to limit the number of preflight requests a client has to make. Now that your server is configured to respond to all types of preflight requests, let's look at ways to reduce the number of preflight requests.

> **NOTE** Some of these suggestions are also useful for supporting CORS on Internet Explorer 8 and Internet Explorer 9. If you'll recall from chapter 2, Internet Explorer 8 and Internet Explorer 9 use a special `XDomainRequest` object to make limited CORS requests.

6.6.1 Maximizing the preflight cache

The simplest way to avoid preflight requests is to take advantage of the preflight result cache. The cache exists for the specific purpose of avoiding multiple preflight requests to the same URL. You can increase the cache time by using the Access-Control-Max-Age header, as shown in the following listing.

Listing 6.11 Configuring the Access-Control-Max-Age header

```
var corsOptions = {
  allowOrigin: createWhitelistValidator(originWhitelist),
```